

Table 2: Number needed to treat for at least 50% pain relief

Number of trials	Drug and dose (mg)	Improved with		% improved		Relative risk (95% CI)	NNT (95% CI)
		Active	Placebo	Active	Placebo		
Six hour outcomes							
1	Rofecoxib 25	66/115	45/118	57	38	1.5 (1.1 to 2.0)	5.0 (3.7 to 7.8)
3	Rofecoxib 50	140/226	70/225	62	31	2.0 (1.6 to 2.5)	3.2 (2.4 to 4.5)
1	Ibuprofen 400	31/49	10/47	63	21	3.0 (1.7 to 5.4)	2.4 (1.7 to 4.2)
2	Naproxen sodium 550	120/181	60/178	66	34	2.0 (1.6 to 2.5)	3.1 (2.4 to 4.4)
Eight hour outcomes							
1	Rofecoxib 25	70/115	44/118	61	37	1.6 (1.2 to 2.2)	4.2 (2.8 to 9.0)
3	Rofecoxib 50	147/226	73/225	65	32	2.0 (1.6 to 2.5)	3.1 (2.4 to 9.0)
1	Ibuprofen 400	30/47	11/47	61	21	2.6 (1.5 to 4.6)	2.6 (1.8 to 5.1)
2	Naproxen sodium 550	121/181	62/178	68	35	2.0 (1.6 to 2.4)	3.0 (2.3 to 4.3)
Twelve hour outcomes							
1	Rofecoxib 25	64/115	45/118	56	38	1.5 (1.1 to 1.9)	5.7 (3.3 to 20)
3	Rofecoxib 50	135/226	74/225	60	33	1.8 (1.5 to 2.3)	3.7 (2.8 to 5.6)
1	Ibuprofen 400	27/49	12/47	55	26	2.2 (1.3 to 3.7)	3.4 (2.1 to 9.2)
2	Naproxen sodium 550	111/181	62/178	61	35	1.8 (1.4 to 2.2)	3.8 (2.7 to 6.1)